

REQUEST FOR TENDER EVENT MANAGEMENT SERVICES: NORTH AMERICA 2027-2029

Reference ID: PROCFY26078

RFT Issue Date: 21 July 2026 AEST
20 July 2026 PDT

Tender Closing Time: 15 August 2026, by 10AM AEST
14 August 2026, by 5PM PDT

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1 OVERVIEW OF THE RFT

1.1 About Tourism Australia

Tourism Australia is the Australian Government agency responsible for attracting international visitors for leisure and business events. We operate in 15 key markets, and our activities include advertising, public relations, trade shows, consumer promotions, online communications, and market research. For more information, please visit our corporate website at www.tourism.australia.com or our consumer website (www.australia.com).

1.2 Purpose

We are seeking tenders from appropriately qualified and experienced suppliers to deliver end-to-end management, strategic planning, and on-site logistical execution for Tourism Australia (TA)'s nominated signature events in the North American market held between 2027 to 2029, in line with the Statement of Requirements (Section 2). We reserve the right to award and contract with one or more suppliers.

1.3 Contact Officers and Clarification Requests

- 1.3.1 Please direct all questions in writing to the Contact Officer via crussell@tourism.australia.com and cc' tenders@tourism.australia.com.
- 1.3.2 Do not contact other Tourism Australia staff about this RFT.
- 1.3.3 To ensure fairness, de-identified questions and answers received before the End of Q&A Period will be shared with all potential tenderers in AusTender.

1.4 Indicative Procurement Timeline

The following is an indicative timetable for this RFT process and may be subject to change:

Key Milestones	Indicative Timing
RFT Issue Date	21 July 2026 AEST 20 July 2026 PDT
End of Q&A Period	7 August 2026, by 10AM AEST 6 August 2026, by 5pm PDT
Tender Closing Time	15 August 2026, by 10AM AEST 14 August 2026, by 5PM PDT
Primary/First Round Evaluation of Tenders	17-28 August 2026
Shortlisted Supplier(s) Presentations	4 September 2026 AEST 3 September 2026 PDT
Second Round Evaluation	September – November 2026
Contract Negotiations (if required)	November 2026
Commencement of Contract	1 December 2026

2 STATEMENT OF REQUIREMENTS

2.1 Background and Strategic Context

Purpose	Tourism Australia (TA) is approaching the market to identify and appoint a suitably qualified, highly experienced event management agency to deliver a multi-year portfolio of signature business-to-business trade events across North America. The primary objective of this procurement is to establish a consolidated commercial partnership that drives strategic consistency, operational efficiency, and financial value across TA's North American event schedule for the 2027 to 2029 period. By partnering with a single event delivery specialist, TA seeks to elevate the creative execution and delegate experience of its hallmark trade events whilst ensuring rigorous financial governance and strict adherence to Commonwealth risk and compliance frameworks.
Description	The successful tenderer will act as the principal event management agency, assuming holistic responsibility for the end-to-end creative design, logistical planning, and onsite operational execution for the following core events: ○ Australia Marketplace North America 2027 and 2029: A large-scale, multi-day trade event connecting Australian tourism operators with North American travel advisors. The 2027 event is to be hosted in Los Angeles, California, while the location of the 2029 event is to be determined. ○ Signature Experiences Luxury Showcase USA 2028: A premium three-city roadshow involving intimate networking events targeting high-net-worth travel designers, luxury consortia and media representatives. One event will be hosted in New York City, New York, with the two other city locations to be determined. ○ Business Events Australia North American Showcase 2028: A highly targeted, boutique familiarisation and networking event for corporate meeting planners and incentive buyers, with the host city to be determined. The scope of services encompasses venue procurement and management, creative thematic design, run-of-show production, delegate registration logistics, third-party vendor management, and comprehensive onsite health, safety, and risk management.
Background	North America remains one of the most critical and high-yielding international source markets for the Australian visitor economy. TA's overarching strategy in this region heavily relies on facilitating direct, high-value commercial connections between Australian tourism products and influential North American travel sellers. Historically, TA has approached the market for these events on an ad-hoc or single-event basis. Transitioning to a multi-year portfolio approach is a strategic shift designed to foster a deeper agency partnership. This consolidated model aims to leverage economies of scale, retain critical operational knowledge year-on-year, and provide the appointed agency with the long-term visibility required to secure highly competitive, multi-year venue and vendor agreements on TA's behalf.
Delivery Location	While the core planning, account management, and pre-event logistics may be executed from the successful agency's primary place of business, the physical delivery and onsite execution of the services will occur exclusively within North America. Specifically, the physical delivery locations are: ○ Los Angeles, California (Australia Marketplace North America 2027) with the 2029 event location to be determined) ○ New York City, New York (Luxury Showcase 2028 – one leg of a 3-city roadshow with the second and third city locations to be determined) ○ North American host city to be confirmed (Business Events Showcase 2028)

2.2 Scope of Requirements

Requirement	Details
Corporate Capability and Demonstrated Track Record	A highly experienced EMC with a proven, verifiable history of delivering high-profile, complex B2B and luxury trade events within the North American market. Service Delivery Requirement ○ Leverage established domestic supplier networks, venue relationships, and regional market knowledge to negotiate premium rates and secure high-demand venues across the United States. Submission Requirement - Package 1: Corporate Capability and Track Record ▪ Submit a detailed corporate profile highlighting your agency's core competencies. ▪ Include three relevant case studies of events delivered within the last 36 months of a similar scale and premium nature, detailing the initial brief, the executed solution, and the measurable outcomes achieved.
Account Management, Staffing and Attendee Experience	A dedicated, highly skilled account management team and sufficient onsite resourcing to ensure consistent, high-quality operational delivery and a premium experience for all event delegates. Service Delivery Requirement ○ Assign a dedicated senior account manager to act as the primary strategic and operational liaison for TA throughout the contract term. ○ Provide dedicated onsite event managers and sufficient support personnel for all events to independently oversee front-of-house operations, including venue layout integrity, VIP hosting, and immediate attendee troubleshooting. ○ Manage comprehensive attendee-facing logistics, including the establishment and operation of onsite registration desks, session flow management, and the procurement and printing of delegate name badges. Submission Requirement - Package 2: Account Management and Resourcing ▪ Submit an organisational chart detailing the proposed account team, including detailed biographies or CVs of key personnel. ▪ Outline your approach to onsite resource allocation, staff contingency planning, and the management of seamless attendee registration and session flow.
Risk Management, Safety and Third-Party Operations	The supplier must have the capability to act as the primary operational lead for onsite health, safety, security and logistics, including proactive risk management, compliance with local regulations and TA governance requirements, effective freight coordination, and the management of third-party vendors in accordance with TA's safety and compliance standards. Service Delivery Requirement ○ Develop, implement, and maintain comprehensive Event Risk Management and Safety Plans for each event, including emergency evacuation procedures, medical incident response, and crowd control. ○ Source, contract, and actively manage all third-party suppliers (e.g., security personnel, cleaners, catering staff, AV technicians, and physical setup crews), ensuring all subcontractors comply with local labour laws and TA's ethical sourcing standards. ○ Manage all end-to-end freight logistics at venue, including secure storage, and timely bump-in/bump-out of TA and partner assets across multiple North American locations. ○ Conduct pre-event WHS site inductions for all staff, sub-contractors, and relevant TA personnel, ensuring absolute compliance with local workplace health and safety legislation. ○ Ensure dedicated onsite security management is in place to protect delegates, physical assets, and confidential event data. Submission Requirement - Package 3: Risk, Safety and Subcontractor Management

	- Provide an example of an Event Risk Management and Safety Plan developed and executed for a recent large-scale corporate event in North America. - Detail your methodology for sourcing, vetting, and managing third-party sub-contractors, specifically addressing how you ensure fair working conditions, verify appropriate insurances, and manage performance. - Outline your proposed approach to managing international and interstate freight logistics for a multi-city roadshow, including strategies to mitigate supply chain delays or customs issues.
Financial Tracking and Cost Management	The supplier must deploy rigorous financial controls, transparent procurement processes for third-party vendors, and accurate budgetary reporting to ensure all events are delivered within agreed financial parameters. Service Delivery Requirement - Manage comprehensive event budgets, providing regular expenditure forecasts and tracking documents to TA. - Ensure transparent pass-through costs for all third-party suppliers, leveraging agency buying power to secure industry discounts or value-adds wherever possible. - Process and manage all vendor deposits, milestone payments, and final acquittals in a compliant and timely manner. Submission Requirement - Package 4: Cost Management Methodology - Outline your budget management framework, specifically detailing how you track expenditure, handle currency fluctuations, and report against rigid expenditure caps. Do not include any proposed management fees, hourly rates, or actual project pricing in this package. All commercial figures must be strictly contained within the separate Attachment 2 - Pricing Response Schedule.
Australia Marketplace North America (September 2027 and September 2029)	The supplier is required to deliver full-scale execution, operational planning, and onsite management for the single-city biennial trade exhibition, acting as the primary B2B platform connecting Australian tourism operators with North American buyers. Service Delivery Requirement - Secure and manage appropriate conference facilities configured to smoothly accommodate up to 120 individual Australian suppliers and approximately 250 total delegates in a standard tradeshow B2B appointment format. This includes managing a centralised registration zone active from day one and equipping two standalone meeting rooms to function as a TA logistics office and a team briefing room. - Deliver a seamless event flow across the 3-day program layout. Day 1 operations require executing delegate registration, a formal conference welcome event, and a TA industry update in the afternoon and evening. Days 2 and 3 require executing standard tradeshow seller-buyer meeting schedules, culminating in a formal conference closing event at the conclusion of Day 3. - Direct and manage dedicated food and beverage footprints within the venue to facilitate continuous operations, including daily breakfast, lunch, networking dinners, and scheduled coffee breaks for approximately 250 delegates. - Coordinate and manage a hotel accommodation block securing up to 225 rooms per night under a minimum 4-star industry rating for 3 nights. The supplier must manage a balanced mix of single and shared or twin occupancy configurations, prioritising a single-site solution over split accommodation models. - Manage the practical execution, spatial footprint allocation, and creative delivery of all confirmed event sponsorships in strict accordance with the packages negotiated by TA. Submission Requirement - Package 5: Marketplace Event Methodology Tenderers must submit a detailed proposal demonstrating their capability, market leverage, and operational methodology to execute the AMNA portfolio. - Propose three comprehensive venue options within Los Angeles County capable of delivering the exact 2027 event scope, including detailed space capacities, menu concepts, floor layouts, and room block configurations. Tenderers must explicitly identify their top recommended

	property and provide full line-item cost estimates for conference facilities, accommodation, food and beverage, and audiovisual setups within the separate pricing response sheet (<i>Attachment 2 – Pricing Response Schedule</i>) ▪ Outline a strategic methodology for sourcing the undetermined US destination for AMNA 2029. This must include a detailed cost-benefit analysis exploring the commercial feasibility, potential volume discounts, and fee-containment advantages of securing a single multi-year venue partnership covering both the 2027 and 2029 events in advance. ▪ Provide a master critical path and venue-sourcing timeline mapping out key room block contraction gates, coupled with a detailed, minute-by-minute logistical run-of-show template used for a recent large-scale B2B trade event. ▪ Propose a comprehensive, 1-page prospectus tailored for a potential Gold Sponsor (e.g., an airline partner, valued at approximately USD \$20,000 to \$30,000). The proposal must detail the specific commercial inclusions, high-impact branding footprints, and creative event activations the supplier recommends providing to maximise the sponsor's return on investment. Historical Context and Event Standard To assist tenderers in understanding the premium scale, format, and delegate experience expected for the Australia Marketplace North America (AMNA) events, tenderers are encouraged to review the execution of AMNA 2025. Reference material detailing the 2025 format can be accessed here: https://www.travelagewest.com/Events/australia-marketplace-north-america-2025 Proposed methodologies for 2027 and 2029 must meet or exceed this established standard of delivery.
Signature Experiences Luxury Showcase USA (January – June 2028)	The supplier must execute a highly tailored, premium three-city roadshow between January and June 2028, designed to inspire and educate elite luxury travel advisors and media representatives, requiring sophisticated creative concepts and thematic design. Service Delivery Requirement ○ Develop and execute bespoke creative concepts, thematic styling, and layout designs that elevate the luxury positioning of the Signature Experiences brand. ○ Source boutique, upscale venue spaces capable of hosting approximately 75 high-end guests per city. Venues must support a four-hour evening schedule featuring a distinct welcome reception footprint, an adjacent seated presentation space, and a dedicated screening room (or premium audiovisual equivalent)/ ○ Coordinate upscale catering capabilities, including substantial canapés and a premium beverage package, tailored to the luxury audience. ○ Manage all local third-party providers, including venue decorators, bespoke menus, gift items, and specialty talent (such as musicians, guest speakers, artists, and photographers). Submission Requirement - Package 6: Luxury Showcase and Creative Methodology ▪ Recommend a program format and a specific, highly suitable venue in New York City that achieves the strategic objective for this leg of the roadshow. <i>Note: Ensure all associated estimated pricing for this proposed venue is detailed exclusively within Attachment 2 – Pricing Response Schedule.</i> ▪ Submit preliminary creative concepts, thematic styling ideas, or mood boards demonstrating an understanding of luxury brand positioning. Historical Context and Event Standard To assist tenderers in understanding the highly tailored, boutique nature expected for the Signature Experiences Luxury Showcase, tenderers are encouraged to review the execution of the recent Toronto leg of the roadshow. Reference material detailing the previous format can be accessed here: https://www.paxnews.com/news/tourism-board/tourism-australia-returns-to-pitch-signature-experiences-luxury-advisors Tenderers should use this as a baseline to inform their premium creative concepts for the New York City activation.

Business Events Australia North American Showcase (July 2028)	The supplier is tasked with the logistical coordination and financial management of a targeted commercial activation for the business events sector. This is a premium, single-city boutique event acting as the primary B2B platform connecting business events focused Australian suppliers with North American buyers. Service Delivery Requirement - Manage the end-to-end logistical coordination and onsite hosting of travelling Australian industry partners and North American buyers (approximately 60 attendees) across a 3-day event program. Day 1 operations require organizing a welcome reception event. Days 2 and 3 require executing standard seller-buyer meeting schedules, with a group dinner on Day 2 serving as the primary social event. - Coordinate and manage a hotel accommodation block securing up to 60 rooms per night under a minimum 4-star industry rating for 2 nights. Deliver the complete event scope strictly within a predefined net budget cap of USD \$150,000. Submission Requirement - Package 7: Business Events Methodology - Propose a strategic program format, ideal event dates, recommended city location, and a specific venue that best serves the target audience. <i>Note: Ensure all associated estimated pricing for this proposed venue is detailed exclusively within Attachment 2 – Pricing Response Schedule.</i> - Recommend and detail a specific program element or activation that would be highly engaging and unique for this North American B2B audience.
Sustainability	The supplier must embed environmentally sustainable practices throughout the event planning and execution lifecycles to align with TA's sustainability objectives. Service Delivery Requirement - Minimise the environmental footprint of all events by prioritising digital collateral, eliminating single-use plastics, avoiding waste, and selecting catering partners focused on local, sustainable sourcing. - Ensure all procured goods and consumables are managed to minimise packaging waste. Submission Requirement - Package 8: Sustainability Approach - Detail three practical, environmentally sustainable initiatives that will be physically implemented across TA's event portfolio.
Value Add/Innovation	The supplier is encouraged to propose strategic enhancements and commercial innovations, or complimentary services that elevate the overall event experience or drive operational efficiencies beyond the baseline requirements Service Delivery Requirement - Implement technological or logistical solutions that streamline attendee registration, enhance B2B networking capabilities, or yield measurable cost reductions during the contract term. Submission Requirement - Package 9: Value Add & Innovation - Highlight any proprietary event management technologies, strategic vendor partnerships, or complimentary services offered at no additional cost that distinguish their proposal and deliver enhanced value for money.

2.3 Deliverables

Deliverable	Description
Creative and Thematic Concepts	Delivery of comprehensive mood boards, styling proposals, and layout designs tailored for all events

Comprehensive Event Project Plans	Detailed project management documentation for all events, outlining critical paths, vendor deadlines, and specific resource allocations.
Event Risk Management and Safety Plans	Delivery of comprehensive, site-specific safety and emergency response plans for every event activation, tailored to local jurisdictional requirements.
Sub-contractor Compliance Register	Provision of a verified register prior to each event detailing all engaged third-party vendors, their scope of work, confirmed insurance currency (Public Liability and Workers Compensation), and confirmation of their adherence to ethical labour standards.
Freight and Logistics Schedule	A detailed tracking document outlining delivery timelines, and secure storage arrangements for all physical event assets.
Venue Sourcing and Contracting	A matrix of thoroughly vetted venue and accommodation options for each event, culminating in the execution of localised venue contracts.
Logistical Run-of-Show	Minute-by-minute operational schedules for all events, ensuring seamless transitions between networking, presentations, and food and beverage services.
Onsite Event Execution	Deployment of dedicated event managers and support staff across all cities to oversee front-of-house operations, registration desks, and delegate coordination.
Post-Event Financial Reconciliation and Reporting	Provision of detailed post-event financial acquittals, consolidated invoices, and qualitative attendee feedback analysis.

2.4 Milestones

Estimated Milestone Date	Description
December 2026	Contract execution, vendor onboarding, and initial strategic planning session.
January 2027	Submission of formal venue and accommodation recommendations for Australia Marketplace 2027.
April 2027	Finalisation of all primary venue and supplier contracts for Australia Marketplace 2027.
60 Days Prior to Each Event	Submission of the draft Event Risk Management and Safety Plans, alongside the preliminary Freight and Logistics Schedule for Tourism Australia's review and endorsement.
30 Days Prior to Each Event	Submission of the finalised Sub-contractor Compliance Register, demonstrating that all third-party vendors have been successfully vetted and onboarded.
September 2027	Successful onsite execution of Australia Marketplace North America 2027.
January 2028	Submission of creative concepts, venue recommendations, and run-of-show plans for the Signature Experiences Luxury Showcase and Business Events Roadshow.
January – July 2028	Successful onsite execution of the Signature Experiences Luxury Showcase
July 2028	Successful onsite execution of the Business Events Showcase
September 2028	Submission of formal venue and accommodation recommendations for Australia Marketplace 2029.

September 2029	Successful onsite execution of Australia Marketplace North America 2029.
December 2029	Contract close-out, final financial reconciliation, and handover reporting.

2.5 Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

KPI	Description	Measure
Operational Event Delivery	The successful and seamless execution of all nominated events within agreed parameters.	Zero critical logistical failures onsite; highly positive satisfaction ratings (85% or above) captured via post-event delegate and internal stakeholder surveys.
Financial Management and Cost Containment	Strict adherence to approved event budgets and accurate financial reconciliation.	Delivery of the Business Events Showcase strictly within the USD \$150,000 expenditure cap; all other events delivered within the approved financial baselines with zero unapproved budget variations.
Creative and Thematic Excellence	The successful implementation of premium styling and event design that aligns with TA's brand positioning.	Stakeholder approval of all creative concepts prior to implementation; consistent thematic execution across multi-city roadshows.
Account Management and Responsiveness	The maintenance of a highly responsive, proactive, and collaborative relationship with the TA North America team, alongside flawless front-of-house delegate management.	100% on-time delivery of Project Plans and Post-Event Reports; continuity of core staffing; zero delegate complaints regarding registration or onsite support; resolution of ad-hoc commercial or operational queries within 24 hours.
Compliance and Risk Mitigation	Absolute compliance with all statutory, regulatory, and contractual obligations, including proactive risk management onsite.	Zero workplace health and safety (WHS) incidents onsite; full compliance with the approved Contract and Risk Management Plan throughout the term.
Safety, Logistics and Sub-contractor Governance	The proactive management of all physical onsite risks, secure and timely freight logistics, and the ethical management of all third-party vendors in alignment with TA's standards.	100% of event freight delivered and secured on schedule with zero customs delays; 100% of third-party vendors verified for insurance and labour compliance prior to bump-in; zero critical safety or security breaches onsite.

2.6 Brand Alignment and Creative Direction

- 2.6.1 While Tourism Australia has provided a baseline programme outline for each event, tenderers are strongly encouraged to develop and propose their own creative direction. All proposed creative concepts, thematic styling, and event branding must strictly align with the overarching Tourism Australia brand identity. Tenderers must refer to the [Tourism Australia Brand Guidelines 2025](#) when developing their creative methodologies.

2.7 Contract Term

- 2.7.1 The proposed contract term is: 3 years
- 2.7.2 The contract will not provide for an option to extend the term further.

2.8 Scope Flexibility and Volume Fluctuations

- 2.8.1 While this RFT outlines the anticipated portfolio of North American trade events for the 2027 to 2029 period, this contract structure establishes absolute operational flexibility. TA retains the unilateral right to amend, alter, rescale, postpone, or entirely remove specific event programs throughout the duration of the three-year term based on fluctuating business needs, budget parameters, or strategic shifts. Tenderers must acknowledge that no minimum volume of work or expenditure is guaranteed under this arrangement. Any subsequent variation or reduction in scope will be managed strictly in accordance with the provided *Attachment 3 – Draft Contract*.

2.9 HSEQ Obligations

- 2.9.1 By lodging a tender, you confirm compliance with applicable Health, Safety, Environment and Quality legislation/standards. We may request evidence during evaluation.

2.10 Security and Privacy Requirements

- 2.10.1 The Service Provider must implement and maintain robust security measures across all physical and digital touchpoints of the event lifecycle. The Service Provider must comply with:
- **Physical Security:** All local, state, and federal security and safety regulations applicable to the event delivery locations in North America, including the provision of comprehensive crowd management, asset protection, and emergency response protocols.
 - **Data Protection and Privacy:** Strict adherence to all applicable Privacy and Data Protection Laws (including the Privacy Act 1988 (Cth)) when collecting, storing, and processing delegate Personal Information, dietary requirements, and registration data.
 - **Data Sovereignty:** Tourism Australia data must not be stored, accessed, or transferred outside of permitted countries without explicit prior written consent from Tourism Australia.
 - **IT Security:** [The Protective Security Policy Framework](#) (PSPF) and the [Australian Government Information Security Manual](#) (ISM), specifically to the extent they apply to the software or digital registration platforms utilised for the delivery of the Services.
 - **Internal Policies:** Tourism Australia's internal Security Instructions and IT Acceptable Use policies, where the agency accesses Tourism Australia systems.
 - **Specific Directions:** Any subsequent directions issued by Tourism Australia regarding the security of personnel, physical assets, or data.

2.11 Insurance Requirements

- 2.11.1 The following insurances are required of the successful tenderer:

Insurance Type	Insurance Amount Required
Public Liability Insurance (PLI)	≥ USD \$2M
Professional Indemnity Insurance (PII)	≥ USD \$1M
Workers' Compensation Insurance (WC)	According to Statutory Requirement

2.12 Transition Arrangements

Phase	Min Requirement and Details
Transition In	To ensure the multi-year project commences properly and structural alignment is established immediately, the following onboarding activities will occur within the first four weeks of contract execution: ○ Implementation Team Establishment: Formalise the joint contract management team comprising the TA North America Business Sponsor, the TA Contract Manager, and the supplier's dedicated Senior Account Manager. ○ Kick-Off Workshop: Conduct a strategic alignment workshop to review the initial project blueprint, clarify the creative direction for the Luxury Showcase, and define the financial reporting cadences. ○ Contract and Risk Management Plan: Finalise and deploy the formal Contract and Risk Management Plan, embedding the escalation matrix, variation processes, and the agreed RACI (Responsible, Accountable, Consult, Inform) resourcing plan. ○ Compliance Verification: Confirm the receipt of all required insurance certificates and any required confidentiality agreements.
Transition Out	At the conclusion of the 2029 Australia Marketplace event, or upon earlier termination, a formal transition-out process will be initiated to ensure all TA assets and data are secured: ○ Financial Finalisation: The supplier must submit all outstanding invoices and a final consolidated account statement indicating all amounts owed or unspent. The TA Contract Administrator will settle outstanding claims and complete final budget acquittals. ○ Intellectual Property and Data Handover: The supplier must securely transfer all TA Intellectual Property back to TA, including creative concepts, thematic designs, high-resolution event photography, delegate databases, and post-event survey data. ○ Secure Destruction of Information: Following the successful handover of data, the supplier must execute the secure destruction of all remaining TA confidential information and delegate Personal Information, providing a formal certificate of destruction to the TA Contract Manager. ○ Contract Closure Review: A final performance review will be conducted to capture supplier feedback, document lessons learned for future North American procurements and formally verify that all technical and financial obligations have been fulfilled.

3 TENDER SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS

3.1 What to Lodge

You must submit the following documents in the specified formats:

#	Document	Description	Format
1	Tender Response Schedule	<i>RFT Attachment 1</i> - Including: - tenderer's details - insurance coverage - details of subcontractors - client references - conflicts of interest - statement of compliance with draft contract (departure clauses and rationale must be provided if partially or non-compliant) - Modern Slavery Questionnaire - signed tenderer's declaration	Word or PDF as a standalone document Presented in English
2	Pricing Response Schedule	<i>RFT Attachment 2</i> – Including: - proposed pricing for the contract term - any critical assumptions for pricing	Excel spreadsheet as a standalone document Presented in English in USD You must not present pricing anywhere else in your submission except in this standalone document
3	Your Proposal	Including: - an executive summary - the 9 Submission Packages (the Proposal) to meet the Statement of Requirements addressing the Evaluation Criteria	Word, PDF, or PowerPoint Presented in English
4	Draft Contract with Markups	<i>RFT Attachment 3</i> – proposed marked-up changes (tracked changes) to the TA Draft Contract terms and conditions – to accompany the statement of compliance with draft contract section from <i>RFT Attachment 1</i> .	Word

3.2 Submission of Tenders

- 3.2.1 You must submit your tender electronically via AusTender (www.tenders.gov.au). Submissions must be successfully completed and received before the Tender Closing Time. Tenders must be presented in English.
- 3.2.2 We encourage you to review the support information and Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) available on [AusTender Help and Information Centre](#). If you require further technical assistance, you can log a support ticket directly with the AusTender team by clicking the 'Assistance' button on the website.
- 3.2.3 To avoid potential delays, we recommend that you familiarise yourself with the AusTender portal and commence your upload well in advance of the Tender Closing Time.

3.3 Tender Closing Time and Validity

- 3.3.1 The Tender Closing Time is 5PM PDT on 14 August 2026 (or 10AM AEST on 15 August 2026). A tender received after the Tender Closing Time will not be considered unless the delay is due solely to our mishandling.
- 3.3.2 Tenders should remain open for acceptance for a minimum of 180 days from the Tender Closing Time.

3.4 Departures, Assumptions or Alternative Proposals

- 3.4.1 You must explicitly list any departures, assumptions or alternatives to this RFT in your tender. If submitting an alternative tender, you must also submit a conforming tender.

4 EVALUATION PROCESS

4.1 Assessment Objectives

- 4.1.1 Tenders will be evaluated to identify the option/s that represents the best overall value for money. We may consider factors such as fitness for purpose, performance history, risk, flexibility and price.

4.2 Conditions for Participation

- 4.2.1 TA will assess all submitted tenders against the following mandatory Conditions for Participation. This assessment will be conducted strictly on a Pass/Fail basis. Tenders that fail to meet any of these conditions will be deemed non-compliant and will be excluded from further evaluation.

Condition	Details
Tender Responses and Schedules	Condition for Participation The tenderer must submit all required responses and response schedules in full by the stipulated Tender Closing Time. Submission Requirement Successful lodgement of all items noted in Section 3.1 prior to the specified deadline.
Ethical Conduct and Practices	Condition for Participation The tenderer must operate under stable ethical governance frameworks and have no unresolved judicial or regulatory findings regarding workplace non-compliance, employee entitlements, or severe breaches of work health and safety laws. Submission Requirement - A signed declaration (executed within the <i>Attachment 1 - Tender Response Schedule</i>) confirming their compliance with all local labour regulations, workplace health and safety laws, and the Commonwealth Supplier Code of Conduct. Tenderers must also declare any historical or pending judicial or regulatory findings regarding workplace non-compliance. - Transparent disclosure of subcontractors (executed within the <i>Attachment 1 - Tender Response Schedule</i>), detailing any intended third-party or offshore arrangements, specifying the legal entity name, corporate address, and the precise scope of tasks to be outsourced.
Modern Slavery Risk Management	Condition for Participation The tenderer must demonstrate an active commitment to identifying, assessing, and addressing modern slavery risks within their operations and multi-tier supply chains. Submission Requirement Tenderers must complete and submit Tourism Australia's Modern Slavery Questionnaire
Conflict of Interest Declaration	Condition for Participation The tenderer must be free from any unmanageable actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest that could compromise their professional impartiality or undermine the commercial and strategic interests of Tourism Australia. Submission Requirement - Tenderers must submit a comprehensive and accurate Conflict of Interest Declaration via the designated <i>Attachment 1 – Tender Response Schedule</i>. - This declaration must explicitly detail any current or recently concluded engagements with competing national tourism organisations (particularly those operating within TA's key target

	markets such as New Zealand, Canada, and South Africa), Australian State and Territory tourism bodies, or other relevant regional tourism entities. Submissions that fail to provide this declaration, or where TA determines an identified conflict cannot be adequately managed through established probity protocols, will be excluded from further participation.
Legal and Operational Capacity to Operate in North America	Condition for Participation Given the physical delivery of services across multiple locations within the United States, the tenderer must be legally equipped to operate within this jurisdiction. The tenderer must possess a formally established operational footprint or act as a registered legal entity with the lawful right to conduct business, employ staff, and execute commercial contracts locally. Where the tenderer does not possess this direct legal presence, they must maintain a formally established relationship with a local partner agency that possesses these rights to act on their behalf. Submission Requirement Tenderers must provide verifiable evidence demonstrating a legitimate, legally compliant operational presence in the target jurisdiction. To demonstrate this capability, tenderers must submit: - Valid local business registration documentation (e.g., certificate of incorporation, local tax registration, or equivalent statutory business licence) demonstrating the legal authority to operate commercially within the United States; OR - A formally executed joint venture or partnership agreement detailing the local partner agency that will fulfil these legal and operational rights on the tenderer's behalf, inclusive of the partner agency's corporate registration details.
Insurance Requirements Coverage	Condition for Participation The tenderer must currently hold, or commit to securing prior to contract execution, the minimum required insurance coverages to protect TA against financial and operational risk. Submission Requirement Formal confirmation within <i>Attachment 1 – Tender Response Schedule</i> of the tenderer's ability to hold Public Liability, Professional Indemnity, and Workers Compensation insurances to the required thresholds.
Financial Viability	Condition for Participation The tenderer must be financially solvent and possess the economic capacity to deliver a high-value, multi-year international contract. Submission Requirement A signed declaration within <i>Attachment 1 – Tender Response Schedule</i> certifying financial stability, alongside an agreement to undergo an external financial viability assessment prior to contract award.
Draft Contract Compliance	Condition for Participation The tenderer must agree to the baseline terms of the Tourism Australia Draft Contract or clearly stipulate areas of non-compliance for commercial assessment. Submission Requirement A statement of compliance executed within <i>Attachment 1 – Tender Response Schedule</i>, accompanied by a marked-up version of the Draft Contract detailing any requested departures and their commercial or legal rationale.

4.3 Evaluation Overview

- 4.3.1 TA will evaluate all tender submissions using a phased approach to ensure a fair, transparent, and highly competitive process that delivers the optimal Value for Money (VFM) outcome. The evaluation will be conducted in the following stages:
- Phase 1: Compliance Screening (Mandatory Conditions for Participation)
 - Phase 2: Technical Evaluation (Weighted Scoring)
 - Phase 3: Shortlisted Supplier Presentations
 - Phase 4: Commercial and Pricing Evaluation
 - Phase 5: Value for Money (VFM) and Risk Assessment
 - Phase 6: Commercial Finalisation and Negotiations

4.4 Phase 1: Compliance Screening

- 4.4.1 Each submission will undergo an initial screening to determine if the Conditions for Participation and mandatory requirements have been met (refer to Section 4.2). Non-compliant tenders will be eliminated from further consideration.

4.5 Phase 2: Technical Evaluation

- 4.5.1 Compliant submissions will progress to a detailed qualitative assessment by the Evaluation Committee. Submissions will be evaluated against the following weighted technical criteria:

Criteria*	Detail*	Weighting*
Corporate Capability and Track Record	Mapped to Submission Requirement - Package 1: Corporate Capability and Track Record What we are looking for: A highly experienced EMC with a proven, verifiable history of delivering high-profile, complex B2B and luxury trade events within the North American market. Assessment focus: The evaluation panel will assess the relevance, scale, and success of the provided case studies. Strong responses will explicitly demonstrate established domestic North American supplier networks, successful high-demand venue negotiations, and a deep understanding of managing premium tourism or luxury brand activations.	10%
Account Management, Staffing and Attendee Experience	Mapped to Submission Requirement - Package 2: Account Management and Resourcing What we are looking for: A dedicated, highly skilled account management team and sufficient onsite resourcing to ensure consistent, high-quality operational delivery and a premium experience for all event delegates. Assessment focus: The panel will assess the calibre, relevant experience, and continuity of the proposed key personnel via the submitted organisational chart and biographies. The assessment will rigorously evaluate the tenderer's approach to front-of-house resource allocation, their staff contingency plans to mitigate personnel shortages, and their methodology for ensuring seamless delegate registration and onsite event flow.	10%
Risk, Safety and Subcontractor Management	Mapped to Submission Requirement - Package 3: Risk, Safety and Subcontractor Management	10%

	What we are looking for: Demonstrated capability to act as the primary operational lead for onsite health, safety, security and logistics, including proactive risk management, compliance with local regulations and TA governance requirements, effective freight coordination, and the management of third-party vendors. Assessment focus: ○ The robustness and comprehensiveness of the provided Event Risk Management and Safety Plan. ○ The transparency and rigor of the tenderer's sub-contractor management framework, particularly their controls against exploitative labour practices in high-risk categories like cleaning and security. ○ Demonstrated experience and reliability in handling complex, multi-state freight and customs logistics.	
Financial Tracking and Cost Management	Mapped to Submission Requirement - Package 4: Cost Management Methodology What we are looking for: Rigorous financial controls, transparent procurement processes for third-party vendors, and accurate budgetary reporting systems, to ensure all events are delivered with agreed financial parameters. Assessment focus: The panel will evaluate the robustness of the tenderer's financial governance framework, independent of their actual proposed fees. The panel will scrutinise the quality of their sample reporting templates, their methodology for managing foreign currency fluctuations, and the strategic maturity of their cost-containment processes. Responses will be highly rated if the supplier demonstrates transparent third-party procurement practices and a proven ability to leverage agency buying power to secure industry discounts.	10%
Proposed Event Methodologies and Creative Approach	Mapped to Submission Requirements: ○ Package 5: Marketplace Event Methodology ○ Package 6: Luxury Showcase and Creative Methodology ○ Package 7: Business Events Methodology What we are looking for: Robust, logical, and highly creative venue options and methodologies for flawlessly executing the Australia Marketplace, the Signature Experiences Luxury Showcase, and the Business Events Showcase events. Assessment focus: <u>Australia Marketplace North America 2027 and 2029 (Package 5) – 30%</u> The structural suitability and logistical logic of the three proposed Los Angeles County venues. The commercial viability and creativity of the 1-page Gold Sponsor prospectus. The maturity of the B2B methodology, the feasibility of the timeline for securing room blocks, and the structural soundness of the logistical run-of-show template. <u>Signature Experiences Luxury Showcase 2028 (Package 6) – 10%</u> The premium nature, suitability, and luxury alignment of the proposed New York City venue and program format. The creativity, sophistication, and brand alignment of the submitted thematic concepts and mood boards. <u>Business Events Australia North American Showcase 2028 (Package 7) – 10%</u> The strategic logic behind the proposed city, dates, and venue selection for a North American B2B audience. The creativity and potential impact of the unique program element, alongside the panel's confidence that the proposed format can be successfully delivered within the rigid USD \$150,000 budget cap.	50%
Sustainability Approach	Mapped to Submission Requirement - Package 8: Sustainability Approach	5%

	What we are looking for: A demonstrated commitment to embedding environmentally sustainable practices throughout the event planning and execution lifecycles, aligning with TA's sustainability objectives. Assessment focus: The panel will evaluate the tenderer's corporate sustainability policy alongside the three specific, practical initiatives proposed for implementation across TA's event portfolio. Strong responses will provide measurable strategies for eliminating single-use plastics, minimising packaging waste, and utilising local, sustainable food sourcing.	
Value Add and Innovation	Mapped to Submission Requirement - Package 9: Value Add & Innovation What we are looking for: Strategic enhancements, commercial innovations, or complementary services that elevate the overall event experience or drive operational efficiencies beyond the baseline requirements. Assessment focus: The panel will assess the tangible value of any proprietary event management technologies, strategic vendor partnerships, or complimentary services offered at no additional cost that distinguish the submission.	5%
TOTAL		100%

4.6 Phase 3: Shortlisted Supplier Presentations

- 4.6.1 Following the Phase 2 desktop evaluation, TA may, at its absolute discretion, shortlist the highest-scoring tenderers to participate in formal presentations. The objective of this phase is to validate written submissions, interrogate the proposed methodologies and creative concepts, and assess the account team capabilities. TA reserves the right to adjust a tenderer's technical score based on the evidence and clarifications provided during these presentations.

4.7 Phase 4: Commercial and Pricing Evaluation

- 4.7.1 TA will conduct a comprehensive evaluation of the commercial and pricing submissions. Pricing will not be evaluated both quantitatively and qualitatively to establish the baseline for the Value for Money assessment. Tourism Australia will assess the total estimated Whole-of-Life value of the contract to determine if the proposed management fees and pass-through costs are realistic, competitive, and commensurate with the level of service and risk transfer outlined in the tenderer's technical response.

4.8 Phase 5: Value for Money (VFM) and Risk Assessment

- 4.8.1 Tourism Australia will undertake a comprehensive comparative analysis to identify the tenderer representing the best overall VFM. This holistic review will weigh the finalised technical scores against the unweighted Whole-of-Life costs. As part of this assessment, TA will apply a macro-level risk overlay, evaluating broader enterprise risks including financial viability, proposed contract departures, and the overall commercial risk profile of the proposed delivery model. Contract award will be driven by the optimal balance of capability, acceptable risk, and cost-effectiveness, rather than price or technical score alone.

4.9 Phase 6: Commercial Finalisation and Negotiations

- 4.9.1 Tourism Australia intends to enter into exclusive commercial negotiations with the preferred tenderer identified through the VFM assessment. The scope of negotiations may include refinements to the pricing structure, management fees, or the clarification of proposed value-adds.
- 4.9.2 Tourism Australia reserves the right, at its absolute discretion, to:

- Formally terminate negotiations if a mutually acceptable commercial agreement cannot be reached within a reasonable timeframe, and subsequently invite the next highest-ranked tenderer into negotiations.
- Execute a Best and Final Offer (BAFO) process if top-ranked tenderers offer indistinguishable Value for Money outcomes.
- Shortlist multiple tenderers to participate in parallel competitive negotiations prior to making a final award decision.

4.9.3 The identification of a preferred supplier does not constitute a binding agreement. Any subsequent contract award remains strictly subject to TA completing all mandatory internal governance processes, securing requisite executive approvals, and the formal execution of a written contract.

4.10 Grounds for Exclusion

4.10.1 We reserve the right to exclude a tender from consideration if it contains a false declaration or misleading information, or if you have an unmanageable conflict or a history of poor performance.

4.11 Negotiations

4.11.1 Negotiations may be undertaken with one or more Tenderers at our sole discretion.

4.12 References

4.12.1 We may request information from a third party that is relevant to the evaluation. By submitting a tender, you authorise us to collect and use this information.

4.13 Consortia and Unbundling

4.13.1 We may select a tender from a joint venture or consortia or select individual elements of a tender to be delivered separately.

4.14 Debriefing

4.14.1 Debriefing opportunities will be provided to both successful and unsuccessful tenderers on request.

5 GENERAL TERMS

5.1 Acknowledgement and Disclaimer

- 5.1.1 We provide this RFT in good faith but make no warranty about completeness, accuracy or forecasts.
- 5.1.2 You are responsible for obtaining all information needed to prepare your tender.
- 5.1.3 By submitting, you confirm you have reviewed this RFT (and any addenda), relevant policies on our website (e.g. Fraud & Corruption, Public Interest Disclosure), reviewed the [Commonwealth Supplier Code of Conduct](#) and made your own enquiries in relation to each.
- 5.1.4 You must rely on your own assessment when preparing your proposal.

5.2 Costs

- 5.2.1 You bear your own costs of responding, regardless of outcome.

5.3 No Contract

- 5.3.1 No contract will be created until a formal written contract is executed by us and a Tenderer.

5.4 Public Statements and Confidentiality

- 5.4.1 Do not publish or publicise this RFT or any related work without our written approval.
- 5.4.2 We will endeavour to keep your tender confidential, however we have public accountability requirements that may lead to disclosure, including under the Freedom of Information Act 1982 (Cth).

5.5 Addenda

- 5.5.1 Before the Tender Closing Time we may issue addenda; extend dates; or clarify or vary requirements.

5.6 Our Rights

- 5.6.1 We reserve the right to accept or reject any tender, seek clarifications, presentations or conduct interviews; accept part or alternate solutions; or (in certain circumstances) discontinue the RFT process.

5.7 Intellectual Property Rights

- 5.7.1 All intellectual property in the RFT remains our property. You are licensed to use the RFT only for compiling your tender. You license us to use and copy your tender for evaluation, negotiation and contract management purposes.

5.8 Tender Ownership and Return of Materials

- 5.8.1 All tenders become our property and will not be returned to you.

5.9 Complaints Handling

- 5.9.1 Complaints should be sent to the Contact Officer via email.